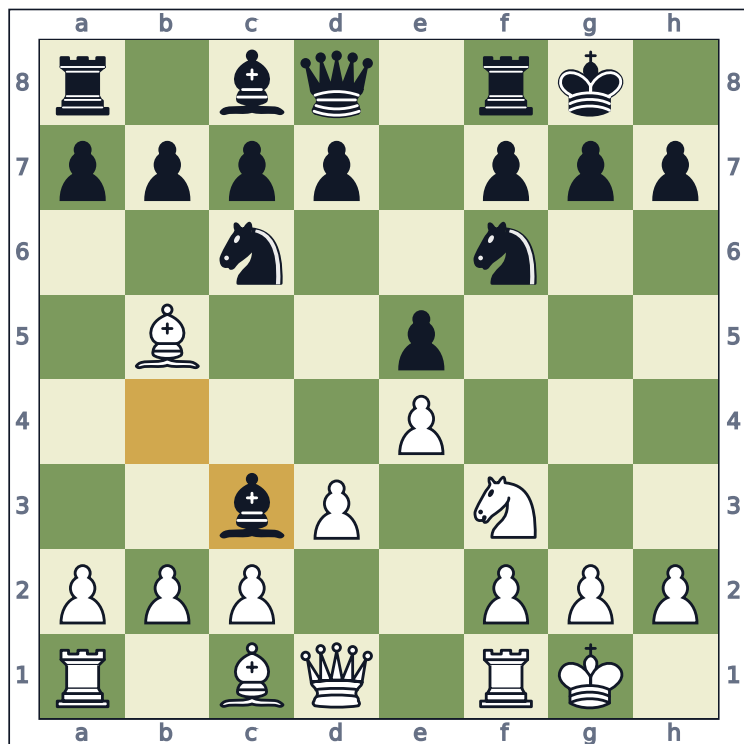


OPEN GAMES AFTER 1.E4 E5

Four Knights Game

ECO C49 | 15 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.18 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Sharp and concrete: initiative, development, and king safety outweigh routine positional rules.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

C49 covers Four Knights Game. Both sides contest the center directly, so development, king safety, and tactical accuracy become visible very early. The diagram uses the featured line Four Knights Game: Spanish Variation.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bb5 Bb4 5. O-O O-O 6. d3 Bxc3

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Develop with threats, prepare d4 under favorable conditions, castle, and use any lead in development before it disappears.

BLACK'S GOALS

Neutralize pressure on e5, complete development, and use ...d5 when it solves the center in one move.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

White's d4 and Black's ...d5 are the central freeing breaks. The f7 and f2 squares demand tactical attention.

PIECE MAP

Knights normally reach f3/c3 and f6/c6 quickly; bishops choose active diagonals according to the central tension. The material imbalance means development and compensation must be calculated, not assumed.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Pawn grabbing and early queen moves are especially dangerous when the center can open with tempo. Do not judge the gambit only by the pawn count; compare king safety, tempi, and open lines.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

White moves next. Black is ahead by about 3 pawn units. Central markers: White pawn on d3, White pawn on e4, Black pawn on e5.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

Among the best openings for learning classical chess because strategic principles and tactics reinforce each other.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C49 line

This section preserves all 15 names and defining routes assigned to C49 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 **Four Knights Game: Spanish Variation**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bb5 Bb4 5. O-O O-O 6. d3 Bxc3

002 **Four Knights Game: Spanish Variation, Alatortsev Variation**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bb5 Bb4 5. O-O O-O 6. d3 Qe7 7. Ne2 d5

003 **Four Knights Game: Spanish Variation, Double Spanish**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bb5 Bb4

004 **Four Knights Game: Spanish Variation, Double Spanish**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bb5 Bb4 5. O-O O-O 6. d3

005 **Four Knights Game: Spanish Variation, Gunsberg Counterattack**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nf6 3. Nc3 Nc6 4. Bb5 Bb4 5. O-O O-O 6. Nd5 Nxd5 7. exd5 e4

006 **Four Knights Game: Spanish Variation, Janowski Variation**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bb5 Bb4 5. O-O O-O 6. d3 Bxc3 7. bxc3 d6 8. Re1

007 **Four Knights Game: Spanish Variation, Nimzowitsch Variation**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bb5 Bb4 5. O-O O-O 6. Bxc6

008 **Four Knights Game: Spanish Variation, Svenonius Variation**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bb5 Bb4 5. O-O O-O 6. d3 Bxc3 7. bxc3 d5

009 **Four Knights Game: Spanish Variation, Symmetrical Variation**
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bb5 Bb4 5. O-O O-O 6. d3 d6

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C49 line

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010 Four Knights Game: Spanish Variation, Symmetrical Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bb5 Bb4 5. O-O O-O 6. d3 d6 7. Ne2

011 Four Knights Game: Spanish Variation, Symmetrical Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bb5 Bb4 5. O-O O-O 6. d3 d6 7. Bg5 Ne7

012 Four Knights Game: Spanish Variation, Symmetrical Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bb5 Bb4 5. O-O O-O 6. d3 d6 7. Bg5 Bxc3 8. bxc3 Qe7 9. Re1 Nd8 10. d4 Bg4

013 Four Knights Game: Spanish Variation, Symmetrical Variation, Blake Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bb5 Bb4 5. O-O O-O 6. d3 d6 7. Bg5 Ne7 8. Nh4 c6 9. Bc4 d5 10. Bb3 Qd6

014 Four Knights Game: Spanish Variation, Symmetrical Variation, Metger Unpin

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bb5 Bb4 5. O-O O-O 6. d3 d6 7. Bg5 Bxc3 8. bxc3 Qe7

015 Four Knights Game: Spanish Variation, Symmetrical Variation, Tarrasch Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nf6 3. Nc3 Nc6 4. Bb5 Bb4 5. O-O O-O 6. d3 d6 7. Bg5 Be6